

Louise Willoughby

PERSONAL STATEMENT

I'm a product focused leader with a hands-on journey that's taken me from sales and support, through data analysis and front-end development, to delivering strategy at a global scale. I understand products end-to-end from the customers using them, to the teams building them, to the systems that hold everything together and I bring that perspective into every decision.

Today, I'm the Lead UX Strategist at [hosting.com](https://www.hosting.com) (World Host Group), where I drive the long-term vision for our global customer panel used across 35+ hosting brands. While my focus is on shaping user journeys and reducing friction, my role is deeply product-driven, influencing roadmaps, prioritising initiatives and ensuring delivery aligns with business goals. I work with cross-functional teams to translate insight from data, research and feedback into features and improvements that move the needle on adoption, retention and revenue.

I care about people, progress and purpose. I've built high performing teams, turned underperformance around, and created strong feedback cultures. I thrive in fast moving, collaborative environments where clarity, prioritisation and measurable outcomes matter and I'm passionate about delivering products that work for both the business and the people who use them.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Career progression from Sales to Head of Product Development, with hands-on experience across every stage of the product and customer lifecycle.
- Delivered a global hosting platform MVP in just 3.5 months, scaling it across multiple brands, and integrating billing, server control and third-party tools. Whilst working with a fully remote, cross-functional team.
- CSPO certified and winner of multiple industry awards, including Developer of the Year and Young Entrepreneur Finalist, for leadership, delivery, and community contribution.
- Built and embedded a product culture focused on user insight, delivery, and collaboration, leading cross-functional change and mentoring team members.
- Active in community and charity work, including fundraising for Herts Young Homeless, WoodGreen, and team mental health initiatives.

EXPERIENCE

[Hosting.com](https://www.hosting.com) / World Host Group (acquired Nimbus Hosting in 2024)

Head of Product Development & User Experience

2019 – Present

Progressed through multiple roles across Nimbus Hosting and World Host Group, culminating in a leadership position post acquisition.

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SKILLS

Product Strategy & Ownership:

Roadmap planning, backlog management, prioritisation, stakeholder alignment, business case development, team mentoring, recruitment.

Product Lifecycle: End-to-end experience from marketing and lead handling to user testing, delivery, and support.

Product Ops & Delivery: Jira, Confluence, HubSpot, WHMCS, Figma, Fullstory, VWO, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, API workflows, Maze.

Technical: Nuxt.js, Vue.js, Laravel, PHP, Tailwind CSS, SQL, GitHub, GitLab, CI/CD tools.

Soft Skills: Empathetic, resilient, commercially minded, strategic, supportive, excellent communicator.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Developer of the Year – Digital Women Awards 2023

Young Entrepreneur Finalist – EVA

Group, culminating in a leadership position post-acquisition. I lead the team behind our global customer panel, used across 35+ hosting brands, and drive the long-term UX vision across the business.

I'm responsible for shaping the roadmap, mentoring developers and product managers/owners and aligning delivery with business goals. My role spans strategic UX direction, cross-functional collaboration and product delivery, ensuring a seamless, consistent experience across brands.

- Defined and led the UX strategy for Hosting.com and associated brands, shaping end-to-end journeys, identifying friction points, and guiding improvements.
- Collaborate with product, CRO, design, marketing, customer care, engineering and agency partners to embed user centred thinking into roadmaps, onboarding flows and feature delivery.
- Provide UX input into product roadmaps, A/B testing agendas, and brand rollouts, ensure design consistency, accessibility and best practices.
- Delivered the MVP of a global hosting platform within 3.5 months, integrating billing systems, server control, and third-party tools to accelerate rollout.
- Use data and behavioural insights from, Maze, VWO and user feedback to inform product decisions, prioritise opportunities and measure impact.
- Established and continuously improved agile delivery processes across the product organisation, training teams in sprint planning, retros and backlog management.
- Act as a strategic advisor to the CCO and commercial leadership team, influencing priorities and aligning UX with broader business objectives.
- Hired and scaled a cross-functional team, mentoring engineers and product owners into senior roles and led performance reviews, growth plans and promotions.
- Increased team visibility through leadership reports, product showcases, and cross-departmental updates.

Earlier Roles at Nimbus Hosting (2019 - 2024)

Head of Development → Deputy to Head of Development → Front-End Developer → Data Analyst → Customer Service & Support → Sales
2019 – 2024

Over five years at Nimbus, I progressed through six roles, gaining end-to-end insight into the customer and product lifecycle. I led the build of core features, coached engineers, introduced agile processes, and supported the transition from dev led to product led delivery.

- Built and maintained the in-house hosting panel using Laravel/PHP, Vue.js, and Tailwind CSS, focusing on performance and usability.

Women's Business Awards 2024

Digital Woman to Watch – 2022 & 2023

Women in Tech Excellence
Nominee – 2024

Author of the Year 2022 – dev.to

REFERENCES

References available upon request.

- Delivered core platform features including WordPress Recipes, CDN tools, Role-Based Access Control, and a new purchase flow.
- Managed feature backlog, reviewed pull requests and led architecture discussions to ensure scalability and consistency.
- Introduced agile ways of working, improving sprint flow, bug tracking, QA handoffs and cross-team collaboration.
- Led product interviews, usability tests, and release notes, turning direct user feedback into actionable changes.
- Recruited and onboarded team members, supporting structured feedback and promotion cycles.
- Mentored developers and helped them grow both technically and professionally through regular 1:1s and peer learning.
- Operated with high autonomy, often building internal documentation, workflows, and delivery processes from scratch.
- Took part in charity and community work, including fundraising events, awareness campaigns, and company green initiatives.

Early Career Experience

Various Administrative & Leadership Roles | 2012 – 2019

Prior to moving into product and development, I held a number of leadership and admin roles where I developed foundational skills in people management, customer service, process improvement, and cross-team coordination. As a Shift Leader at JD Wetherspoon, I managed operations and training across both bar and kitchen teams, often under pressure, and gained first hand experience of supervising, onboarding, and coaching staff in a high demand environment.

- Supervised a mixed team of front and back of house staff, supporting high standards under pressure.
- Created and maintained staff rotas, balanced workloads, and led daily briefings.
- Trained new starters on company procedures, compliance, and customer experience.
- Reviewed team performance and provided day to day feedback and coaching.
- Managed inventory, ordering, and sales forecasting against budget targets.
- Handled cashing up, reporting, and operational handovers as senior team member on shift.

OUTSIDE OF WORK

When I'm not working, you'll find me hiking, building side projects, playing video games, collecting LEGO, or wrangling two cats and a tortoise.